Intelligence framework Octosuite is now available on GitHub

Version 3.1.0 of the open source intelligence (OSINT) framework Octosuite has just been made available on GitHub. Octosuite, a Python-based tool, offers a safe and intuitive interface for quickly searching and exploring data pertaining to a repository, organisation, or user. To identify pertinent data fast, it also searches for themes, commits, and issues. Every search result is exported in a CSV file that can be read by other programs.

Users can begin using Octosuite through a command-line interface (CLI) or graphical user interface. While the latter allows users to search commands from a dropdown menu, CLI is more flexible when processing data in batches.

After installing Octosuite, the user must launch it in the terminal. Octosuite will make an effort to establish three directories at launch time — logs for storing session logs, output for saving CSV files, and download for saving source code via the source command.

Since 26 per cent of firms now use open source investigative tools, the market for open source intelligence is anticipated to develop significantly over the next five years.

For open source investigators, security researchers, and anyone who wants to quickly examine and probe data hosted on GitHub, Octosuite is a crucial tool. For instance, it can be used to look into instances like the 2022 GitHub malware attack, in which a single user account compromised more than 35,000 repositories.

Two security flaws emerge with ImageMagick

The open source image processing program ImageMagick has a few security flaws that might possibly result in information exposure or cause a Denial of Service (DoS) event, according to researchers at Metabase Q (CVE-2022-44268, CVE-2022-44267).

Raster and vector picture files can be viewed, converted, and edited using the free and open source software package ImageMagick. When parsing a PNG picture with a file name that only contains a single dash ('-'), the CVE-2022-44267 vulnerability, a DoS problem, can be activated.

When parsing an image, the CVE-2022-44268 vulnerability is an information disclosure bug that can be used to access any files from a server. The software may have included the content of any external file when it parses a PNG image, for example, to resize (if the ImageMagick binary has permissions to read it).

An attacker must use the ImageMagick program to upload a specially created image to a website in order to remotely exploit the flaws. By including a text chunk that specifies certain metadata, such as the file name, which must be set to '-' for exploitation, the attacker can create the picture. The two flaws impact ImageMagick version 7.1.0-49 of the program; they were fixed in version 7.1.0-52, which was released in November 2022.

New open source ecosystems will receive up to US$ 28 million from NSF in funding

The National Science Foundation (NSF) in the US is aiming to promote the growth of open source ecosystems in STEM (science, technology, engineering and mathematics) subjects, according to a release. The 'Pathways to Enable Open-Source Ecosystems' or POSE programme will not provide funding for currently operating open source ecosystems, tools, or products but will instead concentrate on assisting fresh open source ecosystems. The POSE programme's objectives, according to the statement, are to increase the number of academics and innovators working on and contributing to open source ecosystems, and to establish risk-free and secure development and contribution channels for high-impact ecosystems.

The estimated budget for NSF's 30 to 50 awards is US$ 27.8 million. Many of the projects that it funds "result in publicly accessible, changeable, and distributable